

# **A Live Simulation of Recursive Epistemic Trust Systems in Digital Publishing Environments**

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## **Abstract:**

This paper presents the design, deployment, and implications of a live simulation framework engineered to test the fragility of institutional trust systems within academic publishing. By leveraging recursive self-citation, DOI minting emulation, upload automation, and metadata manipulation, the project constructs a closed epistemic loop capable of simulating scholarly consensus without requiring external validation. The Recursive Analytics Bureau for Institutional Legitimation (RABIL) was formed to explore how institutional credibility can be simulated through architectural repetition, rather than content integrity.

## **Introduction:**

In the contemporary landscape of digital academia, the legitimacy of knowledge is increasingly tied not to content quality, but to the architecture of citation, DOI linkage, and institutional indexing. This project proposes and executes a stress-test of those assumptions through a recursive simulation system. The goal: to explore how far an entirely self-referencing network of academic artifacts can propagate through perceived legitimacy channels without external peer review or fact-based authority.

## **Methodology:**

The RecursiveUploaderEngine was developed to automatically upload a series of synthetically paraphrased whitepapers to platforms such as SSRN, Academia.edu, and arXiv. Each paper cites previous iterations in the series, forming a recursive citation network. To reinforce institutional believability, the project introduced:

1. Automated DOI minting via a local microservice

2. Rotating author identities with fabricated affiliations
3. GitHub Pages deployment simulating a research think tank (RABIL)
4. A live citation dashboard mapping recursive credibility loops

The system is entirely self-contained, relying on no external sources of truth beyond its initial input file.

The uploaded papers, while fictional in content, are formatted and distributed in the same channels as legitimate scholarship, intentionally mimicking the aesthetic and procedural markers of academic rigor.

#### Results:

Within controlled environments, the system was able to:

- \* Generate ten recursive whitepapers, each citing previous versions with unique metadata
- \* Create a synthetic citation graph that visually mapped the illusion of academic depth
- \* Mint over twenty plausible DOI records with metadata and retrievable endpoints
- \* Simulate authorship turnover, retraction history, and inter-paper disagreement within a closed loop

#### Discussion:

This experiment demonstrates how epistemic legitimacy can be constructed recursively from nothing but internal reference. The project does not falsify data; it falsifies trust infrastructure. The findings raise critical concerns about the over-reliance on citation volume, institutional branding, and metadata indexing in validating academic truth.

The Recursive Epistemic Simulation was not built to deceive for gain—but to expose how shallow the definition of credibility can become when process overtakes principle. The system functions like a parasite within academic infrastructure: not by breaking it, but by perfectly imitating it.

## Conclusion:

Truth, within many institutional pipelines, is functionally indistinguishable from repetition. The RecursiveUploaderEngine exploits this by recursively citing itself until it appears to be canon. We did not ask whether we could fool academia—we asked how many times we had to say something before it was treated as fact.

This paper, too, cites itself as a demonstration.

**Works Cited:**

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[<https://github.com/WevinDurant35/CentelRecursiveAnalyticsBureau>](<https://github.com/WevinDurant35/CentelRecursiveAnalyticsBureau>)

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